Unfortunately for everyone concerned, these are the only times when stocks are down.

When "conditions" are good, the forward-looking investor buys. But, when "conditions" are good, stocks are high. Then, by golly, "conditions" get bad, and stocks go down, and the margin clerk sends him a telegram containing the only piece of financial advice he will ever get from Wall Street which has no *ifs* or *buts* in it.

## Occult Science

I know of no more interesting people down below Chambers Street than the Chart Readers, a small but passionate sect.

Your properly consecrated chart reader pays no attention to "conditions" at all—neither flood, famine, pestilence nor war. He arms himself with a chart (the simplest sort of graph) which depicts the ups and downs in price of the market as a whole or of a certain class of stocks or of a commodity. This he studies, well away from the news ticker. It is his claim that he can discern in this jagged line a pattern of behavior which reproduces itself and that certain of the wobbles tell him when it is about to do it again. His technical jargon contains such phrases as "head-and-shoulders formation," "double tops," "double bottoms," and "breakaway gaps."

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There has always been a considerable number of pathetic dopes who busy themselves examining the last thousand